

Our topic today is the dualist view that we are (either wholly or in part) immaterial things.

You may recall that we came up with two dualist answers to
the identity question:

A large blue circle with a white drop shadow, containing the text "Simple dualism: I am an immaterial soul" in white. The text is centered and arranged in four lines.

**Simple
dualism: I am
an immaterial
soul**

A solid blue circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is centered and reads: "Fusion dualism: I am a combination of a soul and a body".

Fusion
dualism: I am
a combination
of a soul
and a body

**Soul
survival:**

X is me just in
case X is the
same immaterial
soul as me

Fusion survival:

X is me just in case X
has the same immaterial
soul as me and is the
same material thing as
me

For right now we're going to set aside the question of which of these views is better.

Instead, we're going to ask a more fundamental question: is there any good reason to believe in the existence of immaterial souls?

Let us say that a belief is **self-evident** just in case we can be certain, just by thinking about it, rule out the possibility that it is false.

But the following also seem, for all we have said, quite plausible:

We have no
sensory
experience
of
immaterial
souls.

It is not
self-evident
that there
are
immaterial
souls.

We have no good
argument for the
existence of
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